ECCO · GUIDING COMPETENCE, SHAPING FUTURES

Your first guidance session

A preparation checklist for learners and parents

You do not need a finished answer before the session. That is what it is for. A little preparation turns a vague chat into a useful one.

Before the session

- [ ] List the school subjects you enjoy most and least, including the ones that hold your attention, not only the ones with the best grades.
- [ ] List activities you choose to do outside school: a hobby, a club, something you help with at home.
- [ ] Bring your latest KJSEA result or report card if you have one. It is one input among several, not the whole picture.
- [ ] Parents and guardians: plan to attend, especially for the first session.
- [ ] Come with open questions rather than a fixed idea of the "right" answer.
- [ ] Write down any worries about pathways, subjects or the future.

What to expect in the room

A guidance officer usually starts by asking about school life broadly before narrowing in on subjects or pathways. This is how we get an honest read on a learner rather than a rehearsed one. Expect open questions such as "What is a lesson you did not want to end?" more than closed ones.

Questions you may want to ask

- What does each pathway really involve day to day?
- Which pathways match my strengths and interests?
- Which schools near us offer the pathway I am considering?
- What could I do next to explore this before I decide?

Bring with you

- [ ] This checklist and the reflection worksheet
- [ ] Report card or KJSEA result
- [ ] A pen and notebook

Based on ECCO's article "How to prepare for your first guidance session". Book a session at www.educareer-connect.org/book.